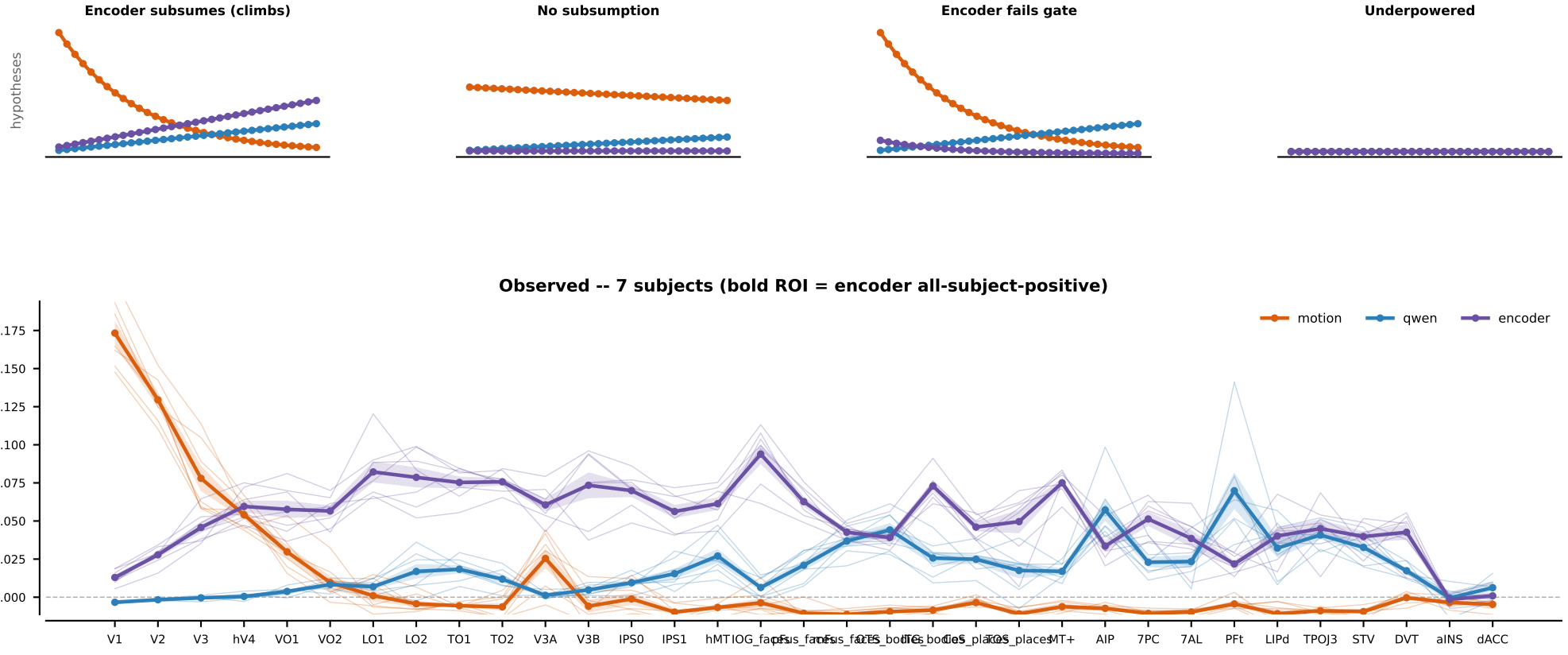

CONTENT-BAND SUBSUMPTION (§3; n=7 subjects; grey = subjects, bold = mean +/- SEM; GSN-noise-ceiling-normalized leave-one-band-out UNIQUE variance per ROI up the hierarchy). Banded ridge with MOTION energy, QWEN semantics, and the V-JEPA ENCODER band; each band's UNIQUE variance is the held-out R^2 lost when it is dropped. The gate: does the encoder carry unique variance in high-level / lateral-occipitotemporal / parietal / STS cortex (not just early visual), and does it subsume motion there? Top: candidate worlds, same plot.

WHAT WE EXPECT (and why): Motion UNIQUE confined to EARLY VISUAL (a pooled transformer smears retinotopic precision, so motion should retain unique variance only at the occipital pole), encoder UNIQUE CLIMBING into higher-order cortex (the gate passes), QWEN in category-selective + association cortex. If the encoder unique variance is ~0 in higher-order, the tuning manifold there is noise and the geometry analyses are built on sand (gate FAILS).

READING (candidate; the call is yours): Encoder UNIQUE > 0 in all 7/7 subjects in 31/33 ROIs -- the gate PASSES across the hierarchy. Motion UNIQUE is all-subject-positive in 5/8 early-visual ROIs but only 0/25 higher-order ROIs -> motion is subsumed outside early visual. The V-JEPA encoder is a strong content model where the directional effect lives; the higher-order tuning manifold is real.